IA02: Client Interview Evidence and Requirement Transformation

Interview record

Field	Detl
Date	During semester, Group 19 client meeting
Medium	In-person Q&A with the business owner/manager
Participant role	Restaurant owner / manager, Brny Bites
Evidence type	Written Q&A notes (transcript provided)
Team file	https://github.com/AbdiWaris/DE-DCIT208-GROUP-19 - docs/00-client-brief.md

Summary of what was sd

The following questions and answers are from the group interview conducted with the client (owner/manager of Brny Bites) by Group 19. **Business:** Brny Bites sells fast food including Check Check, shawarma, pizza and other items from one branch. Customers currently order in person, by phone or via WhatsApp. Staff record orders manually, which causes lost orders, stock shortages and difficulty tracking sales. **Why software:** The client wants to manage orders, sales, customers and stock more efficiently. Expected outcomes are faster service, better record keeping, easier stock management and accurate sales reports. **Ordering:** The client wants online ordering, scheduled orders and order cancellation with a time limit. Customers should create accounts so their order history is saved. **Menu:** Around 20–30 items with photos. Prices change sometimes (ingredient cost). Customisable orders wanted (extra chicken, extra sauce, different sizes). **Payment:** Cash, Mobile Money and card. Customers can pay before delivery or at collection. Receipts must be generated. **Delivery:** Own riders.

Fee depends on distance. Customers want to track order status (preparing → ready → out for delivery).

Inventory: Track ingredients (rice, chicken, oil, flour, vegetables, drinks, packaging). Low-stock alerts. Unavlable items hidden automatically. **Staff roles:** Owner, manager, cashier, kitchen staff, rider - each with different permissions. Only owner/manager see financial reports and change settings. **Reports needed:** Dly, weekly and monthly sales; best-selling items; stock; expenses; delivery; profit. **Notifications:** SMS/eml when order is received, preparing, ready and delivered. **Technology:** Mobile-friendly website first, mobile app later. Basic offline support wanted. Devices: smartphones, tablets, one shop computer. **Security:** Login required. Role-based access. Automatic data backups. **Budget/timeline:** Limited budget - prioritise core features. First version in 2–3 months. **Future:** More branches, loyalty points/discounts, promotions, discount codes, reviews, more payment integrations.

Personal question set (prepared before the meeting)

#	Category	Question
1	Workflow	Walk me through what happens from the moment a customer orders until the food leaves the shop.
2	Workflow	Who touches an order (cashier, kitchen, rider) and in what order?
3	Pn point	What goes wrong most often with orders today?
4	Pn point	What takes the most time during a busy period?
5	Data	How do you currently record sales and stock?
6	Data	How do you work out the delivery fee per customer?
7	Success	How would you know the system is working well after one month?
8	Success	Which feature would save you the most time if it worked tomorrow? Which feature would save you the most time if it worked tomorrow?
9	Security/privacy	Who should be able to see customer phone numbers, addresses and dly sales figures?
10	Flure/exception	What should happen if a customer pays by Mobile Money but the money does not arrive?

Requirement transformation

Raw statement (from interview):

> *"Customers should be able to see whether their order is being prepared, ready, or out for delivery."*

Element	Content
Functional requirement	The system shall display the current status of a customer's order (received, preparing, ready, on_the_way, deliv cancelled) on the customer's order history page, updated in real time when staff change the status.
Non-functional requirement	A status change made by staff shall be visible to the customer within 10 seconds of being saved. The status fiel shall be an ENUM with exactly the six values above so no invalid state can be stored.
User story	As a customer, I want to see my order's current status, so that I know when to expect my food without calling t shop.

Acceptance criteria	AC1: Given a placed order, when staff set status to "preparing", then the customer's order page shows "Prepari AC2: Given status "on_the_way", then the page shows "On the way" and the rider's name if avlable. AC3: Giv status "delivered", then the order is marked complete and no further changes are allowed by non-owner staff. A A customer cannot see another customer's order status (TC-19).
API / interface implication	admin/update_order.php sets the status; my_orders.php reads it. A future real-time update would need polling WebSockets.
Data implication	orders.status ENUM already exists with the six values. updated_at timestamp records when it last changed.
Test idea	TC-24 (existing): staff sets status → customer page shows updated status. TC-19: customer sees only own ord
Open question	Will the client want push notifications (SMS/eml) on each status change, as they mentioned? That needs an external messaging provider.

Mapping table:

Interface	Data	Validation	Risk
Customer order page (my_orders.php), staff admin board (admin/index.php)	orders.status ENUM, orders.updated_at	Only valid ENUM values accepted; status transitions should follow a defined flow (e.g. cannot go from delivered back to received)	Any staff role can currently any status, including cance delivered order - BUG-01 role guard on update_orde

Reflection

Before the interview I assumed the mn problem was just taking orders online. After reading the full Q&A, I realised the client's deeper pn point is losing track of orders entirely - orders placed by phone or WhatsApp that get forgotten during a busy period. This changed how I think about the status-tracking feature: it is not a nice-to-have, it is the core of what the client needs. I had also assumed the delivery fee would be a fixed amount, but the client sd it depends on distance. Our current implementation uses a fixed

demo fee of GH₵10 (BUG visible in checkout.php), which means this requirement is unmet. If I were writing the requirements document agn I would mark distance-based delivery fee as a priority for the next sprint rather than leaving it as a demo value. The interview also made me think more carefully about the role permissions the client was clear that only the owner and manager should see financial reports, yet
our current admin dashboard shows revenue totals to all staff roles.